

漢字

KANJIDOKU

Sudoku that leaves you with a word

5 puzzles from the book

There are 100 in it.



Nine characters, not nine numbers

Kanjidoku is sudoku. If you have done a sudoku you already know the rule, and it does not change: every row, every column and every outlined box must contain each character exactly once.

The only difference is that the nine symbols are kanji instead of the digits 1 to 9. You do not need to know what they mean to solve the grid. A symbol is a symbol. But every puzzle prints its characters in a numbered key at the top of the page, with readings and meanings, and by the time you have written 火 nine times in nine different places you will find you know it.

That is the whole idea. Nobody learns a character by looking at it once. You learn it by needing it.

IF THE CHARACTERS LOOK LIKE SOUP

They will, at first, and there is a legitimate shortcut. The key numbers every character from 1 to 9. Solve the grid in pencil using the numbers, then go back and write the characters in. You get the puzzle and the writing practice, in that order, and after three or four grids most people stop needing the numbers.

THE TWO TECHNIQUES YOU NEED

The last empty seat

Look at a single cell. Cross off every character that already appears in its row, its column and its box. If exactly one character survives, it goes there.

The only home left

Look at a single row, column or box and pick one character. Cross off every cell in that unit where the character cannot go. If exactly one cell survives, the character goes there.

No puzzle in this book needs anything harder than those two. If you find yourself wanting to guess, there is a move you have not spotted yet.

The word at the end

Two, three or four cells in every grid are shaded and carry a small number. They are always empty at the start, so you cannot read the word without solving the puzzle first.

When the grid is full, read those cells in numbered order. You will have a real Japanese word, built out of characters you have just spent twenty minutes with. Write it into the boxes at the foot of the page with its reading and meaning; the answer is at the back alongside the solved grid.

WORKED EXAMPLE

業	妻	操	卒	老	後 ^②
卒	老 ^①	後	業	操	妻
後	操	業	老	妻	卒
老	卒	妻	後	業	操
妻	後	老	操	卒	業
操	業	卒	妻	後	老

This grid is already solved.

Cells 1 and 2 are shaded. Read them in that order:

老後 rōgo
ろうご
life after work

Both characters were in the key at the top of the page all along, so you already have the reading and the meaning.

HOW THIS SAMPLE IS ORDERED

The grids grow one step at a time. Six by six, then seven, eight and nine. Each size needs exactly that many characters, which is why the sets stay tight. The four-by-fours are in Volume One.

Two of them are jigsaws. Boxes have to be rectangles, so the size has to divide: nine is three by three, six is two by three. Five and seven are prime, so those grids use irregular regions instead.

Easier characters first. Every grid here is N2, so the sets are ordered by how common their characters are in print instead.

Some characters will be familiar, and some words are longer. The grids are built around N2 but borrow an easier character where the theme wants one; the index gives every character its level. Thirteen of the hidden words are four characters long, and the boxes under the grid tell you which.

After the work stops

① 操 misao sō san
みさお / ソウ・サン

to operate; to handle

② 業 waza gyō gō
わざ / ギョウ・ゴウ

business; vocation

③ 後 ushiro ato go kō
うし(ろ)・あと / ゴ・コウ

behind; after

④ 妻 tsuma sai
つま / サイ

wife; spouse

⑤ 卒 sotsu shutsu
そつ(する) / ソツ・シュツ

to graduate

⑥ 老 ō iru rō
お(いる) / ロウ

old age; to grow old

業	妻			老	②
	①		後	業	
				妻	卒
老	卒				
		老	操		
	業			後	老

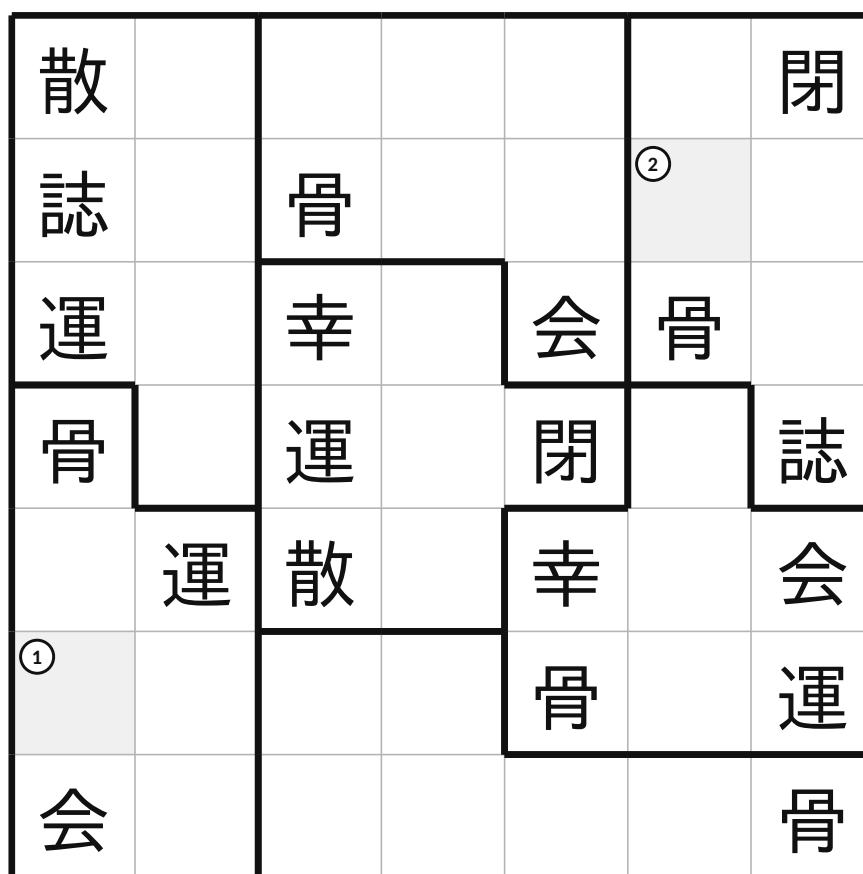
THE HIDDEN WORD

1	2
---	---

reading _____
meaning _____

Nothing to do with skill

- ① 幸 saiwa i kō さいわ(い) / コウ
happiness; blessing
- ② 運 hako bu un はこ(ぶ) / ウン
carry; luck
- ③ 会 a u kai e あ(う) / カイ・エ
meeting; meet
- ④ 閉 to jiru hei と(じる) / ヘイ
to close
- ⑤ 散 chi ru san ち(る) / サン
to scatter
- ⑥ 誌 shi シ
a magazine
- ⑦ 骨 hone kotsu ほね / コツ
a bone



THE HIDDEN WORD

1	2
---	---

reading _____

meaning _____

The gentle way

① 坂 saka han
さか / ハン
slope; incline

② 道 michi dō
みち / ドウ
road; way

③ 柔 yawa raka jū nyū
やわ(らか) / ジュウ・ニュウ
soft; gentle

④ 草 kusa sō
くさ / ソウ
grass

⑤ 書 ka ku sho
か(く) / ショ
write

⑥ 司 tsukasado ru shi
つかさど(る) / シ
an official; to administer

⑦ 挟 hasa mu
はさ(む) / キョウ・ショウ
to hold between

⑧ 清 kiyo i sei shō
きよ(い) / セイ・ショウ
pure; purify

		坂	柔				挟
	道		草				清
①	司		道				
坂				道		司	
	柔		坂				道
				清		坂	
司				柔		書	
清				挟	草	②	

THE HIDDEN WORD

1	2
---	---

reading _____
meaning _____

Rounding it off

① 四 ^{yot tsu shi yon}
よっ(つ) / シ・よん
four

② 捨 ^{su teru sha}
す(てる) / シャ
to throw away

③ 五 ^{itsu tsu go}
いつ(つ) / ゴ
five

④ 入 ^{i ru nyū ju}
い(る) / ニュウ・ジュ
enter; insert

⑤ 輪 ^{wa rin}
わ / リン
wheel; ring

⑥ 植 ^{u eru shoku}
う(える) / ショク
plant

⑦ 押 ^{o su ō}
お(す) / オウ
to push

⑧ 角 ^{kado kaku}
かど / カク
angle; corner

⑨ 居 ^{i ru kyo ko}
い(る) / キョ・コ
to be; to reside

	居	押			捨			
	植				入			②
①			輪				居	五
	五	輪			植			角
		植		輪		押		
角			居			捨	植	
押	輪				居	③		
			押				入	
	④		四			植	捨	

THE HIDDEN WORD

1	2	3	4
---	---	---	---

reading _____
meaning _____

The natural hot spring

① 天 ame ten
あめ / テン
heavens; sky

② 然 zen nen
ゼン・ネン
so; in that way

③ 温 atata ka on
あたた(か) / オン
warm

④ 泉 izumi sen
いずみ / セン
a spring of water

⑤ 帯 o biru tai
お(びる) / タイ
a belt; a zone

⑥ 熱 atsu i netsu
あつ(い) / ネツ
heat; temperature

⑦ 厚 atsu i kō
あつ(い) / コウ
thick; kind

⑧ 包 tsutsu mu hō
つつ(む) / ホウ
to wrap

⑨ 床 toko shō
とこ / ショウ
a floor; a bed

熱		②	天		床			
				包	然			③
泉	帯	包			熱			
	床	天				温		熱
然		熱			④	天		帯
包		温				厚	然	
			帯			然	温	厚
			然	泉				
①			厚		温			泉

THE HIDDEN WORD

1	2	3	4

reading _____
meaning _____

Solutions

Characters in grey are the ones you had to work out; black ones were given. The note under each word is the reason that word was worth hiding.

業	妻	操	卒	老	後 ^②
卒	老 ^①	後	業	操	妻
後	操	業	老	妻	卒
老	卒	妻	後	業	操
妻	後	老	操	卒	業
操	業	卒	妻	後	老

1. AFTER THE WORK STOPS

老後 ろうご
life after work

老後 is the part of life after work: retirement, seen as a period rather than as an event. It is the word in every advertisement for a pension, and it pairs naturally with the 操業 in this grid, which is a factory running.

散	骨	誌	幸	運	会	閉
誌	会	骨	閉	散	運 ^②	幸
運	閉	幸	誌	会	骨	散
骨	幸	運	会	閉	散	誌
閉	運	散	骨	幸	誌	会
幸 ^①	誌	会	散	骨	閉	運
会	散	閉	運	誌	幸	骨

7. NOTHING TO DO WITH SKILL

幸運 こううん
good luck

幸運 is good luck: happiness and fortune. 運 is also to carry, and the two senses are connected: your luck is what has been carried to you, the way 運命 (うんめい, unmei), fate, is what carries you along.

書	清	坂	柔	司	道	草	挟
挟	道	司	草	坂	書	柔	清
柔 ^①	司	挟	道	草	坂	清	書
坂	書	草	清	道	挟	司	柔
草	柔	清	坂	書	司	挟	道
道	挟	書	司	清	柔	坂	草
司	草	道	挟	柔	清	書	坂
清	坂	柔	書	挟	草	道 ^②	司

33. THE GENTLE WAY

柔道 じゅうどう
judo

柔道 is the gentle way, and the 柔 is the whole point of it: the art is named for yielding rather than for force. 道 as a way of doing something runs through 書道 (しょどう, shodō) and 茶道 (さどう, sadō) as well.

入	居	押	五	四	捨	角	輪	植
輪	植	五	角	居	入	四	押	捨
①四	捨	角	輪	植	押	入	居	五
捨	五	輪	入	押	植	居	四	角
居	四	植	捨	輪	角	押	五	入
角	押	入	居	五	四	捨	植	輪
押	輪	捨	植	入	居	③五	角	四
植	角	四	押	捨	五	輪	入	居
五	②入	居	四	角	輪	植	捨	押

47. ROUNDING IT OFF

四捨五入

shishagonyū
ししやごにゅう

rounding to the nearest whole

四捨五入 is one of the few pieces of arithmetic with its own phrase: throw away four, take up five. Anything ending in four or less is discarded, anything in five or more rounds up. Every Japanese schoolchild learns it by this name rather than by a rule.

熱	温	②然	天	帶	床	泉	厚	包
厚	天	床	泉	包	然	熱	帶	③温
泉	帶	包	温	厚	熱	床	天	然
帶	床	天	包	然	厚	温	泉	熱
然	厚	熱	床	温	④泉	天	包	帶
包	泉	温	熱	天	帶	厚	然	床
床	包	泉	帶	熱	天	然	温	厚
温	熱	厚	然	泉	包	帶	床	天
①天	然	帶	厚	床	温	包	熱	泉

70. THE NATURAL HOT SPRING

天然温泉

tennenonsen
てんねんおんせん

a natural hot spring

天然 is nature and 温泉 is a hot spring, so 天然温泉 is one that comes out of the ground hot on its own. The phrase exists because a great many baths do not: heat the water yourself and you have a 銭湯 (せんとう, sentō), a bathhouse. The sign on the door is telling you which one you have walked into.

Writing it out

Solving teaches you to recognise a character. Writing teaches you to remember it. Trace the grey model, then fill the rest of the row from memory.

Two rules of stroke order cover most characters: **top before bottom**, and **left before right**. Where they conflict, a horizontal stroke usually comes before the vertical one crossing it. 十 is drawn across, then down. Stroke order is not pedantry. It is what keeps a character legible when you write it quickly, and it is how a paper dictionary is indexed.

The dotted cross is there so you can judge proportion. Most of a character's legibility lives in how it sits in the square rather than in the strokes themselves.

操					to operate misao みさお	業					business waza わざ
後					behind ushiro うし (ろ)	妻					wife tsuma つま
卒					to graduate sosuru そっ (する)	老					old age oiru お (いる)
幸					happiness saiwai さいわ (い)	運					carry hakobu はこ (ぶ)
会					meeting au あ (う)	閉					to close tojiru と (じる)
散					to scatter chiru ち (る)	誌					a magazine shi シ
骨					a bone hone ほね	坂					slope saka さか
道					road michi みち	柔					soft yawaraka やわ (らか)
草					grass kusa くさ	書					write kaku か (く)

There are ninety-five more

Volume Three holds **100 puzzles** and every character of N2, each with its readings and meaning printed on the page you meet it.

Full solutions. Every grid worked out, with the hidden word, its reading and a note on where the word turns up in real Japanese.

A complete index. All 562 characters, with every puzzle each one appears in, for when one turns up three grids later and you cannot place it.

Writing practice. Squares to write in for every character in the book, with a grey model to trace and the stroke-order rules explained.

THE SERIES

Kanjidoku N5 and N4. Where the series starts: about 280 characters, six four-by-four warm-ups, and the vocabulary everything after it assumes.

Kanjidoku N3. The book before this one. About 370 characters, and the compounds the sets here treat as ordinary words.

Kanjidoku N1. Everything left. Nobody finishes N1 in a hurry.

PLEASE SHARE THIS

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KANJIDOKU.NET for the rest of the series, and the other samplers



MIND QUESTS